

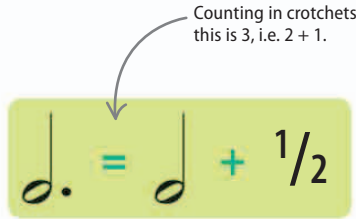
Dotted notes

When a note is followed by a dot, it makes the note $1\frac{1}{2}$ times longer. The dotted quarter note shown below is $1\frac{1}{2}$ times longer than a quarter. In the same way, a dotted eighth note is $1\frac{1}{2}$ times longer than an eighth, and a dotted half is $1\frac{1}{2}$ times longer than a half.



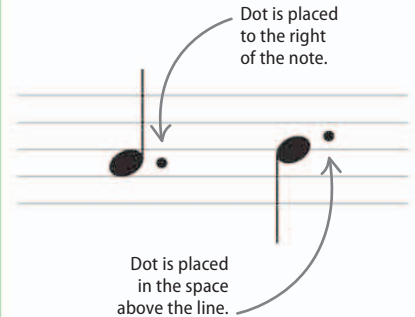
▽ Dotted half

Half a half note is a quarter note. Therefore, a dotted half has the same time value as three quarter notes.



Writing dotted notes

Dots are placed after the note head, to the right. This is easy if the note head is in one of the spaces of the staff, but what if it's on a line? The dot would be harder to see, so instead it goes in the space above.



△ Placing the dot

Shown here are two dotted quarter notes, one in a space and the other on a line. The second note is on a line, so its dot is placed in the space above.

Double-dotted notes

Double-dotted notes also exist. The second dot adds another $\frac{1}{4}$ of the original note value, so that a double-dotted quarter note is $1\frac{3}{4}$ as long as a quarter.



▽ Double-dotted eighth note

Double-dotted notes are much less common than dotted notes. Double-dotted eighth notes are sometimes combined with a thirty-second note.



Note value sums

Different combinations of note values “add up” to make the same total. Just as in math, you can find the lowest common denominator to check the sum. For instance, the lowest common denominator in the first example is an eighth note.



△ 1

Two dotted quarter notes have the same total time value as one dotted half note. Counting in eighth notes, this is $3 + 3 = 6$.



△ 3

The dotted rhythm—dotted eighth note and thirty-second together—is very common. Each unit here lasts one quarter note.



△ 2

In quarter notes, this is $1\frac{1}{2} + 1\frac{1}{2} + 1 = 4$. Or in eighths, $3 + 3 + 2 = 8$. This rhythm is often used in popular music.



△ 4

Double-dotted eighth notes are sometimes paired with thirty-second notes to make a jerky rhythm.